



PROGRESS REPORT

Sierra Leone: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-07 · 165 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-07.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A National Innovation and Digital Strategy 2019-2029 is the standing frame, with a Digital Development Policy under it. The strategy runs on a three-part philosophy of digital identity, digital economy and digital governance, and on three principles - mobile-first, country-as-AI-lab and hybrid technology systems (strategy). The sector policy that operationalises it, Towards a Digital Economy, was issued in 2021 (policy). Both predate the current ministry, and neither has a published mid-term review, delivery report or successor in the base. The strategy's own window closes in 2029.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The Digital Development Policy 2021 is the sector policy, and an open-source software first policy was approved by Cabinet in July 2026. The sector policy was issued in 2021 as the ministry's own instrument (policy). Government ICT officers and digital leads validated a first open-source software policy for the public sector at a workshop in November 2025 (validation), and Cabinet announced its approval in July 2026 (approval). No implementation guidance or compliance route under either instrument is held.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A National Broadband Strategy 2023-2028 is published, above a spectrum framework that exists as a regulator's stated position rather than an instrument. The strategy was published by the ministry in October 2024, a year into the period it covers (strategy). The regulator set out its asks on spectrum pricing and management at an international congress in March 2026 (framework). That is a position, not an instrument: no consultation, draft or adopting decision follows it. The regulator does publish the operators' current network tariffs (tariffs). No target, milestone or delivery report under the broadband strategy is held, and its window closes in two years.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A Government Service Bus and X-Road data exchange layer is piloting, with a World Bank supervision mission tracking it. The exchange layer is piloting on X-Road under the Ministry of Finance, with no production date, connected agencies or governance rules published (layer). A World Bank implementation support mission of September 2025 took the service bus as one of its subjects (mission). A roadmap in the ordinary sense - sequenced, dated, with an owning institution - is not held. What exists is a build in pilot and a supervision record of it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Strategy is in development, with a draft readiness diagnostic produced and consultations run. The draft diagnostic and the consultations are what the base holds; no strategy text, timetable or adopting decision is on record (strategy). What exists instead is an artificial-intelligence-in-government partnership already delivering training, and a public awareness campaign on deepfakes. Both are recorded separately, and both run ahead of the strategy that would frame them.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	Subscriber registration data may not leave the country without the regulator's prior approval, under regulations made in 2020. Regulation 22(3) of Statutory Instrument No. 35 of 2020 provides that subscribers registration information shall not be transferred outside Sierra Leone without prior approval by the Commission, and regulation 22(4) requires any such request to justify its purpose; regulation 19 requires the Commission to keep a central subscriber information database (regulations). That is the whole of the localisation rule in the base: it reaches one data class held by one sector's licensees. No general rule on where government or personal data may be stored is on record, and the data protection Bill that would set one is not enacted.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	Cabinet approved a National Data Protection Policy in April 2026, above a National Data Strategy issued in 2023 and updated with donor support. The policy was approved by Cabinet on 21 April 2026, and the same decision authorised the Bill that would give it force (policy). The data strategy carries January 2023 as the date on the document; the ministry's own index files it as February 2023 and the formal launch was later again, so three dates exist for one instrument. It was updated over five months with donor support and aligned to the continental data policy framework (strategy , update).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	Two sectoral instruments and no national one: a SLEITI Open Data Policy from 2016 and an open data programme at the information commission. The extractive industries transparency initiative adopted its own open data policy in 2016, covering the data it holds (policy). The Right to Access Information Commission runs open data as one of its programmes (programme). What the base does not hold is a national open data policy, a licensing regime, or any instrument binding ministries generally. The two on record bind one sector and one commission.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	Cabinet authorised a Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill in April 2026, and the country has had no data-protection law in force throughout the period. The Bill was finalised in November 2025 and Cabinet approved the policy and authorised the Bill on 21 April 2026 (bill , finalisation). No data-protection law has been in force at any point in the period. That is the frame for everything else in this unit: a biometric register covering most of the population, subscriber data disclosed to police, an identity migration in pilot and two competing identity platforms, all operating with no statutory data-protection regime behind them.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 is in force and unamended, with no prosecution under it reported. The Act was gazetted on 25 November 2021 and the text is on the national legal information institute (Act). It remains in force and unamended, and no prosecution under it appears in the base (status). That absence is the finding worth carrying: a statute reaching the conduct exists, and the mobile-money fraud wave recorded elsewhere has produced no reported case under it.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The National Civil Registration Act 2016 is the governing statute, with a replacement Bill validated in November 2025. The 2016 Act establishes the National Civil Registration Authority as an independent body with its own board and a confidentiality duty (Act); a draft Civil Registration and Identification Bill completed final national validation on 19 November 2025 and is not yet before Parliament (Bill). The subscriber regulations phase-out of unregistered cards was announced on 30 July 2026, linking registration to the national identification number, and the instrument's own text is not held (regulations). Government conceded on 4 August 2026 that the linkage is incomplete (linkage). That concession matters because the fraud response recorded elsewhere rests on registration and identity verification as its principal control, and the control is admitted to be partial.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The National Payment Systems Act 2022 is the governing statute, with a Public Financial Management Act 2026 in consultation above it. The payment systems Act is Act 8 of 2022, gazetted on 23 June 2022, with subsidiary legislation made under it (Act). A draft Public Financial Management Act was consulted on in Freetown in August 2026 covering digital payments; no text, parliamentary stage or commencement date is published (draft). The communications Act was tested against the mobile-money fraud wave in a published legal analysis in July 2026 (Act). Between them and the cybercrime Act the country has statutes that reach the conduct. What it does not have, recorded separately, is a rule allocating the loss.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A public-private dialogue was convened to operationalise the Electronic Transactions Act 2019, seven years after enactment, and the Act as enacted and gazetted is not held. The dialogue ran over two days in July 2026 with donor support (dialogue , framework). The Act as enacted and gazetted is not held; every automated route to the text failed as at August 2026, and what the base has is a record of the instrument rather than its provisions (record). An Act that needs a dialogue to operationalise it seven years after passage is the clearest instance in this unit of the gap between enactment and effect.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The Statistics Act 2002 establishes Statistics Sierra Leone as a body corporate for official statistics, and is unamended in the base. The Act was gazetted on 7 November 2002 as an Act to establish Statistics Sierra Leone for the collection, compilation, analysis and dissemination of official and other statistics (Act). No amendment, review or replacement is on record, and the statistical strategies recorded separately run under it rather than change it. A census Act sits alongside it in the same published compilation.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The Right to Access Information Act 2013 is in force, and a Bill that would carry the access regime forward completed national validation in November 2025. The 2013 Act creates a right of access, a proactive publication duty with approved publication schemes, a schedule of exemptions and an oversight commission (Act). The Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill went through nationwide consultations from September 2025 (consultations), a pre-legislative session in October (session) and final national validation in November (validation). It is not enacted and no parliamentary date is set, so the 2013 Act is the operative instrument throughout.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	Data protection authority	Cabinet authorised repeal of the information commission Act and a merged dual-mandate authority covering data protection and access to information. The existing Right to Access Information Commission would be repealed and replaced by a single authority holding both mandates (merger). No establishing text, commencement date, budget or staffing is published. Until the Bill passes, the country has an access-to-information regulator and no data-protection regulator at all.	ADVANCED
Data protection	National data protection readiness	Data protection by design training was delivered to the state technical team, while police requests for subscriber data are answered with no warrant requirement or oversight mechanism on the record. The training was delivered in August 2026, and no curriculum, attendance figure or follow-on compliance requirement is published (training). An operator answers police requests for subscriber verification data, and no warrant requirement, oversight mechanism or reporting duty governing those disclosures is on the record (disclosures). Training the builders while the disclosure route is ungoverned is the shape of readiness here: the design principle is being taught and the statutory basis does not exist.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The country attended the inaugural board meeting of a continental health intelligence body in August 2026, and no constitutive instrument, budget or data-sharing arrangement is published. Membership was taken up and the inaugural board meeting attended (membership). Nothing published states what the body does with member states' health data, which is the question a country with no data-protection law in force most needs answered before joining a health information hub.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	A Nigeria-Sierra Leone Digital Transformation Cooperation Framework was signed in November 2025, naming know-your-customer alignment and ECOWAS-aligned digital trade principles. The framework was signed at a bilateral mission in Freetown on 21 and 22 November 2025, with two technical partnerships and a joint working group on a 30-90-365 day action plan; its stated objectives include alignment of digital know-your-customer standards, shared data and AI governance frameworks, and ECOWAS-aligned digital trade principles (communique). The country reports to the ECOWAS Parliament on its domestic position (report), and ratifies regional instruments as they arise - the African Road Safety Charter in September 2025 (charter) and ECOWAS air transport supplementary acts in February 2026 (acts). None of that is harmonisation of digital law. The framework is a cooperation instrument with an action plan, not a binding rule.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	Free roaming with two neighbours took effect in May 2025, a third agreement was signed in November 2025, and networks were interconnected at the Guinea border. The three-country free roaming took effect on 2 May 2025 (roaming), and a further agreement with a fourth neighbour was signed at a regional summit in November 2025 and remains planned (agreement). Networks were interconnected at the Pamelap border in June 2025 (interconnection). That border link is also where the country's search for cable redundancy runs: it has one landing station on record and is seeking a second route through the same neighbour.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	The Nigeria framework names cross-border payment interoperability and GovCloud interoperability; the only binding rule is the regulator's approval requirement for subscriber data. The bilateral framework of November 2025 sets cross-border payment interoperability, GovCloud interoperability and shared data governance among its objectives, on a joint working group and an action plan (communiqué). Against that, the operative domestic rule is narrow: subscriber registration information may not be transferred outside the country without the regulator's prior approval (regulations). No general transfer regime exists, because the data protection Bill that would create one is not enacted.	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE
Standards	National quality standards	The Standards Bureau holds 204 national and 156 regional standards, and an open-source software policy binds the public sector with no recorded application. The bureau's standards department publishes and promotes standards, and its own overview records 204 national and 156 regional standards, most adopted from international bodies (overview); the trade ministry warned importers in November 2025 to meet new iron rod standards (enforcement). The open-source software policy was approved in 2025 and reaches the base through coverage of a university curriculum event (policy). No implementation guidance, compliance route or procurement decision is recorded under the software policy, and no digital or data standard appears in the bureau's published set.	NO CHANGE
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The Standards Bureau holds 204 national and 156 regional standards, mostly adopted from international bodies, and began enforcing new iron rod standards in November 2025. The bureau's own overview records 204 national and 156 regional standards, most of them adopted rather than originated (overview). The trade ministry warned importers in November 2025 to meet new iron rod standards (enforcement). No digital, data or interoperability standard appears in the adopted set as published, and no conformity assessment figures are held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A Technology, Innovation and Entrepreneurship Advisory Council held its inaugural meeting in February 2026, and the data protection Bill was consulted on nationwide. The advisory council was convened by the ministry and met for the first time on 5 February 2026, presented as a move from isolated pilots to a coordinated national approach (council). Nationwide consultations on the data protection Bill concluded in Bo in September 2025 (consultations), and a final national validation followed in November (validation). Parliament's own standing orders govern how business reaches the House (orders). No membership list, terms of reference or minutes are published for the advisory council.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Criminal libel was repealed by the Public Order (Amendment) Act 2020; media regulation now runs through the Independent Media Commission. The 2020 Act repealed Part V of the Public Order Act 1965 - defamatory and seditious libel - and renumbered what remained (Act). The Independent Media Commission issued a ruling against an outlet in August 2026 (ruling), and the information commission presented its sixth annual report in November 2025 (report). The base holds the repeal and two institutional acts under it. It holds no measure of press freedom, no count of complaints, and no assessment of how the commission's rulings bear on reporting.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The FY2026 estimates carry NLe 46,808,900 for the communications, technology and innovation ministry, at proposed stage and almost entirely recurrent. The ministry's vote is Head 135, proposed at NLe 46,808,900 for FY2026 - NLe 45,746,500 recurrent against NLe 1,062,400 capital (estimates). Bilateral budget discussions for FY2026 opened in September 2025 (discussions), and the investment board separately proposed a Le 22 million budget to launch 24-hour business registration (board). One head of four is held. No vote is on record for the communications regulator, the innovation directorate or the civil registration authority, the appropriation act itself is not published, and a capital line under three per cent of the ministry's own total is the whole of the domestic capital provision the base can see.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Five bilateral instruments in fifteen months - Nigeria, the United States, the United Arab Emirates, and standing frames with India and the European Union. A digital transformation cooperation framework with Nigeria was signed in November 2025 (communique); a US\$129 million health cooperation memorandum with the United States on 22 December 2025, with a stated protection of data sovereignty (memorandum); and a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with the United Arab Emirates on 2 February 2026, naming artificial intelligence first among priority sectors (agreement). The standing frames are the European Union's Multi-Annual Indicative Programme 2021-2027 (programme) and India's tele-education and training relationship (brief). Only two name a digital deliverable. The rest name digital cooperation as a sector and leave the instrument to a later agreement that is not in the base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	An innovation investment fund was announced with a target stated at an exhibition, and a smartphone financing scheme was announced between an operator, a bank and a handset maker. The fund's target was stated at a digital public goods exhibition in July 2026, with no manager, structure, first close or committed capital held (fund). The financing scheme is a commercial arrangement, and no price, interest rate, eligibility test or uptake figure is stated (scheme). Device affordability is the constraint the usage-gap evidence points at, and the only instrument aimed at it is a private arrangement whose terms are unpublished. The largest private commitment on the ledger is the incumbent mobile operator's own: US\$50m of self-funded capital announced in October 2025 to modernise the network towards 4G and 5G readiness and open new district sites (modernisation). No coverage or subscriber outcome is published against it.	ADVANCED
New investments	Development-partner project financing	A US\$137m regional digital integration operation was approved in March 2026, and technical assistance for census digital mapping was committed for the 2026 population census. The operation was approved by the lender's board on 13 March 2026 (operation). The census mapping assistance is a commitment record rather than a delivery report: no enumeration date, mapping coverage or equipment is stated (assistance). Between them these are the only two development financings the base holds for this unit, and one of them is the largest single instrument in it.	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The state operator is being relaunched as a mobile virtual network operator, with a commercial partner appointed in April 2026. The investment partner was appointed in April 2026 (relaunch). No launch date, subscriber target, spectrum arrangement or wholesale price is published. A state operator re-entering the market as a virtual operator on a competitor's network is a structural choice the record states without explaining.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	20.8 per cent online - 1.85 million users against 7.02 million offline - with the ministry's own account of the gap resting on coverage rather than use. The measured position is 1.85 million users against 7.02 million offline (usage). The regulator's 2019 annual report is the base's earliest published sector position (report). Since then the ministry has reported progress in coverage terms - a connectivity address in September 2025 (address) and a new network site at Mathonkra in Tonkolili district in October (site). Coverage is not usage, and the gap the ministry reports against is a usage gap. No series is published that would let a reader see the two move apart.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Mobile affordability	Sierra Leone entered the regional free roaming agreement in February 2026, removing charges with Liberia and Ghana. The agreement entered in February 2026 removes roaming charges among Sierra Leone, Liberia and Ghana, with the regulator stressing that full implementation still had to follow. It is a cross-border price, not a domestic one: nothing in the base publishes a Sierra Leonean retail tariff or an affordability ratio against income.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The national fibre backbone reaches 14 of 16 districts, a marginal advance with the last two districts unstated as to timing. Backbone coverage was reported at 14 of 16 districts in May 2026 (backbone , centre , ambition). No date, cost or route is stated for the remaining two, and no utilisation or last-mile figure accompanies the coverage count. The evidence recorded separately is that the gap in this country is usage rather than reach.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A wholesale operator added new subsea capacity to its West Africa network in July 2026, and an ECOWAS four-country cable cleared feasibility in October 2025. The added capacity serves a wholesale route across several West African states and is not a national asset (capacity). 2025-07-11 - a ministry delegation assessed feasibility and public-private models for a second landing routed via Guinea , and nothing further on that route is held. 2025-10-22 - separately, ECOWAS member-state experts with their technical and financial partners reviewed and approved the feasibility study for a second submarine cable serving Cabo Verde, Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea-Bissau at a Monrovia workshop; no route, cost, landing site or construction date is published, and neither record says whether the two are the same project. A single landing station is the most concentrated infrastructure risk in this ledger, and until one of these is built it stays that way.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	One exchange is on the global register: Michcom-IX in Freetown, carrier-neutral, with five peers and 60G of capacity and no IPv6. The exchange is run as a non-profit initiative by Michcom Limited and is open-access and carrier-neutral, taking internet service providers, mobile operators, content delivery networks, cloud providers and academic and government networks; its record shows five peers, six connections, 60G of total capacity and no IPv6 (record). Five peers is the whole of the domestic peering fabric the base can see. No traffic volume, no national exchange run by the regulator, and no policy requiring local peering appears anywhere in the record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite service has been licensed since June 2024 with three local resellers, and twelve universities were connected under the national broadband strategy. The service has been licensed since June 2024 and operates through three local resellers (licence , universities). Twelve universities were connected through a local reseller under the broadband strategy (connection). Licensed satellite service reaching universities and, separately, health facilities makes one foreign operator the connectivity of last resort for two national systems at once.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A national data centre was commissioned in April 2026, an identity agency facility was reported operating in August, and an operator backup facility opened in November 2025. The national facility at the regulator's headquarters was commissioned by the head of state in April 2026 (national). The identity agency's director-general reported a tier-three facility operating in August 2026 (identity), and an operator opened a backup facility outside the capital in November 2025 (backup , figures). Three facilities commissioned inside eighteen months, and no capacity, tenancy or redundancy arrangement is published for any of them.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	Freetown draws between 56 and 70 MW with the main hydroelectric dam down to about 5 MW in the dry season, and the districts share 15 MW between three cities. The Deputy Minister of Energy stated on 7 April 2026 that Freetown receives between 56 and 70 MW, that the Bumbuna hydroelectric dam is generating only about 5 MW on reduced dry-season water levels, and that the gap is bridged by the Karpowership, the CLSG interconnection and the Kingtom power station; he gave 15 MW for Bo, Kenema and Kono together, attributed load shedding to seasonal factors, damaged cables, faulty transformers and vandalism, and said generator fuel costs often exceed revenue collected (statement). Generation projects were reported again at a June 2026 press conference (conference), and a World Bank water project reaching five million people was approved in September 2025 (water). Nothing in the base addresses data centres directly. Three data centres and a national backbone recorded elsewhere sit on this supply, and no site-level power or water figure for any of them is published.	ADVANCED
Energy	Grid reliability	Freetown draws 56 to 70 MW with the main dam down to about 5 MW in the dry season, against a solar and storage plant that came fully online in July 2026. The Deputy Minister of Energy stated on 7 April 2026 that Freetown receives between 56 and 70 MW, that the Bumbuna hydroelectric dam generates about 5 MW on reduced dry-season water levels, that the gap is bridged by the Karpowership, the CLSG interconnection and the Kingtom power station, and that Bo, Kenema and Kono share 15 MW; he attributed load shedding to seasonal factors, damaged cables, faulty transformers and vandalism (statement). The solar and storage plant was commissioned in July 2026, and no generation outturn or grid-availability series is held for it (plant). Dispatch centres and control upgrades are provided for in a compact and have not moved (compact). Grid reliability is the unstated dependency under three data centres and a national fibre backbone, and the base still holds no availability series against which to read it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Rural electrification	The National Energy Compact commits to a Rural Electrification Agency and 560,000 off-grid households by 2030, on 36 per cent access today. The compact records 36 per cent electricity access and 1.5 per cent clean cooking access, sets an estimated US\$2.2 billion investment requirement across five pillars, and commits government to establishing a Rural Electrification Agency to reach at least 560,000 households with off-grid supply by 2030, building on 104 solar mini-grids and over 150,000 stand-alone solar systems (compact). The standing delivery vehicle is the Rural Renewable Energy Project, funded by the UK at GBP 37,739,328 and implemented by UNOPS (project), and a EUR 22 million facility to accelerate green mini-grid deployment launched in October 2025 (facility). The agency is a commitment, not an institution: no establishing instrument, board or budget line for it is held.	ADVANCED
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	The National Data Centre at the regulator's headquarters was commissioned in April 2026, and the procurement authority demonstrated e-procurement modules ahead of a national rollout. The headquarters building was commissioned in April 2026, housing the National Data Centre and network operations and co-locating the regulator with the ministry (centre); the President commissioned it in a ceremony reported the same month (commissioning). The public procurement authority showed procurement planning and price norm modules of its electronic system to its leadership in March 2026, ahead of national rollout (modules). No availability figure, disaster recovery arrangement, or software asset position is published for any government system in the base.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	Over 100 government ICT professionals were trained in enterprise architecture in October 2025; who runs the national systems day to day is not established. The training covered designing, developing and maintaining enterprise architecture and reached more than 100 government ICT professionals (training). The ministry's Directorate of Technology is the body with the remit (directorate). A training count is not a capacity measure. No staffing figure, skills audit or operations report from the regulator, the innovation directorate or the civil registration authority is held, and that gap is recorded separately as unsettled.	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	The regulator confirmed ongoing cybersecurity incidents in a July 2026 public notice, and six offences under the Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 were mapped onto the mobile-money scam in a published analysis. The public notice confirming ongoing incidents was issued on 30 July 2026 (notice), and a coordination centre is named as a delivery partner in senior civil-service training (centre , strategy). A published legal analysis maps six offences under the 2021 Act onto the scam (offences). No prosecution under any of them is on record. The regulator ran a consumer education campaign on online fraud from July 2026 (education). Awareness is doing the work the statute is not.	MIXED a coordination centre and a public notice on live incidents while the statute in force is being read against a fraud wave rather than applied to it

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	The finance ministry reported piloting a data exchange layer on an open-source exchange platform, above a service bus that reaches the base only as a prototype terms of reference. The pilot was reported in August 2026 (pilot), and the service bus above it is held as a prototype terms of reference and nothing further (prototype). No connected agency count, go-live date or governing instrument is published. The identity agency's own argument, made at the same consultation, is that identity should come first — which is a position on sequencing rather than a description of what exists.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A Health Information Hub launched in January 2026, under a digital health roadmap whose own window closes at the end of the year. The ministry launched the hub on 20 January 2026 as a national health information system (hub). The roadmap running 2024 to 2026 sets strategic objectives over leadership and governance, strategy and investment, and services and applications (roadmap), and a National Health Compact was agreed in December 2025 (compact). What is not held is the interoperability itself: no list of systems the hub connects, no standard it exchanges on, and no successor to a roadmap that expires this year.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	A national education data hub is being built on DHIS2 to connect fragmented systems and link learner records to the national identity number. The ministry is partnering with the HISP network to connect fragmented education data into a single DHIS2-based hub and link every learner's school records to the national ID (hub). A unique learner identifier system and data warehouse went out to tender through UNICEF in October 2025 (tender). The system being displaced is the education data explorer the innovation directorate has run since 2020 (explorer). No go-live date, connected system list or award under the learner-ID tender is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	An amended memorandum between the social action commission and the statistics office was signed in April 2026 to take the social registry towards national coverage. The commission and Statistics Sierra Leone signed the amended memorandum on 8 April 2026, to expand the Social Protection Registry for Integrated National Targeting and improve programme delivery (memorandum). A separate inter-agency agreement on gender-based violence case referral was signed in February 2026 between the gender ministry, the social action commission and the anti-corruption commission (agreement). Both are bilateral instruments between named agencies. No general legal basis for data sharing between government registers exists, which is recorded separately as an unsettled gap.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	An open-source migration of the identity system completed pilot and is still seeking funding, while a second national digital identity platform went to private-sector consultation. The migration pilot is complete and full implementation is still seeking funding (migration , identity first). A separate platform is being built with a foreign government and a foundation, and went to private-sector consultation on a trusted digital identity framework in August 2026 (consultation , dialogue , partnership). The identity agency has warned publicly against parallel identity systems, so the duplication is contested inside government rather than merely observed from outside. One route is funded and unbuilt, the other piloted and unfunded.	MIXED an open-source migration piloted and unfunded while a second identity platform is being built and the identity agency warns against parallel systems

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	The identity agency reported about 93 per cent population coverage, and registration, card issuance and coverage are three different metrics kept apart in the record. Coverage was reported to a digital public infrastructure consultation in August 2026 and has not moved in the base since a 2025 statement of the same figure (coverage , services , opportunity). Card issuance is tracked separately because registration, issuance and coverage measure different things and conflating them would overstate what a person actually holds (issuance). An ethnographic study documents human intermediation in enrolment – brokers standing between the citizen and the register – reported as analysis rather than as a state position (brokers).	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The identity system runs on the authority's own Tier III data centre, with a migration to an open-source platform piloted but unfunded. The authority reports the centre as Tier III-compliant and carrying the national biometric register, though no certification document is held (centre). The migration to MOSIP has completed its pilot and full implementation is unfunded, as the authority itself states (migration). The authority's own institutional description sets out its ICT infrastructure (authority). An unfunded migration is the sharpest fact here: the maintenance position rests on a platform the owner intends to leave.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	Identity verification now gates services: banks were directed to enforce the national identification number in all transactions, and the permit portal requires registration. The central bank set commercial banks a deadline to enforce the identification number in all transactions (directive). The unified permit portal, the online channel for work and residence permits, requires registration for a number before an application can be made (portal). The verification platform behind this was launched with the first securitized multipurpose biometric cards in January 2023 (launch), and coverage stands at about 93 per cent with a live eKYC platform (coverage). No authentication volume, uptime figure or failure rate is published for any of it.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	The civil registration authority announced that the Maternal and Child Health Handbook will be valid for birth registration, routing registration through the health contact. The Director General announced the recognition at a high-level coordination meeting in Freetown on 5 March 2026, sponsored by the health ministry, JICA and UNICEF; the handbook was piloted in selected districts from 2019 to 2021 and adopted as a national standard in 2022 (handbook). It is an announcement, not an instrument. No regulation, circular or commencement date gives it effect, and no registration figure is published against it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	The National Civil Registration Act 2016 puts civil registration and identity in one authority, and a health record is to become a valid registration document. The 2016 Act establishes the authority as an independent body with its own board and a confidentiality duty, holding both the civil register and the identity function (Act). The authority marked the sixth Africa CRVS Day in August 2023 on the integration of civil registration with identity (integration), and announced in March 2026 that the maternal and child health handbook will be recognised for birth registration (handbook). Institutional integration is not technical integration. No figure is held for births registered and identity numbers issued from the same event.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	A national digital farmer registry was agreed for integration with the identity number in May 2025, and an agricultural voice-response platform is reported 98 per cent complete. The registry integration was agreed with the agriculture ministry in May 2025 and has not moved since (registry). The voice-response platform is described as 98 per cent complete, which is the ministry's own description (platform); no launch date, language coverage, call volume or cost is stated (platform). Neither carries a data-protection arrangement, in a country with no data-protection law in force.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The National Payment Systems Act 2022 is the governing statute, and the central bank went to market for a fintech strategy in September 2025. The Act is Act 8 of 2022, gazetted on 23 June 2022, with subsidiary legislation made under it (Act). The bank sought expressions of interest on 17 September 2025 for consultants to develop a fintech strategy and a fintech regulatory policy framework (notice), and separately directed banks to enforce the national identification number in all transactions (directive). Neither an award under the notice nor any text of the strategy is held. The re-platforming of the bank's own settlement and clearing systems is recorded separately and remains unestablished.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	Social grants are paid through mobile money: the social action commission reports SLE 3.7 million of businesses created and recalibrated in Falaba on grants disbursed through Afrimoney. The commission reported the Falaba disbursement in July 2026, with the grants routed through the Afrimoney wallet (grants). An ECOWAS-supported project for displaced and stateless people launched in January 2026 states that beneficiary tokens will be distributed through the Sierra Leone Commercial Bank (project). Two programmes, two channels, and no national government-to-person payments architecture behind either. No beneficiary count, transfer value or reconciliation arrangement is published.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	The revenue authority began distributing smart tax machines to 10,000 registered businesses from 31 August 2026, and put non-tax revenue on a mobile application. Nationwide distribution of smart goods and services tax machines to 10,000 registered businesses began on 31 August 2026 (distribution). The commissioner-general said they complement the existing electronic cash register system and are intended to support accurate record-keeping, strengthen compliance, let businesses issue valid receipts and reduce revenue leakages (distribution). Surveyors were trained at Makeni in July 2026 to collect service fees through the authority's non-tax revenue mobile payment application, in a provincial rollout (application). The authority's statutory basis is the National Revenue Authority Act 2022 (Act). The machines are counted against no published total of registered businesses, no distribution schedule, no cost and no baseline for the leakage they are to reduce.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	The national instant payment switch is in service, and a World Bank supervision report is the only published account of its build. The switch launched in February 2025 and no transaction volume, participant count or availability figure is published for 2026 (switch). The implementation status report of the financial inclusion project that built it is the base's account of the delivery (report). Business-to-business and business-to-government use is not separated out anywhere in the record; the switch is reported as a national rail without a breakdown by payer type.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	A national instant payment switch launched in February 2025 with full integration from April, and a payments platform with a messaging chatbot and code settlement launched in April 2026. The instant phase launched on 13 February 2025 with full integration from 1 April 2025 (switch). The payments platform launched in April 2026 with a messaging-app chatbot and code-based settlement (platform). No transaction volume, participant count or availability figure is published for the switch at any date, so what the rail actually carries is unmeasured.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	A prepaid card requiring no bank account and a virtual card through an operator app both launched in 2026, and financial inclusion reaches the base only as a named-analyst assessment. The prepaid card launched in May 2026 with a bank partner and requires no bank account (prepaid), and a virtual card launched in March 2026 through an operator application (virtual). A savings product paying annual interest through an application and short codes launched in November 2025 (savings), and a multi-currency wallet and card launched in April 2025 (wallet). The inclusion rate itself is a named-analyst assessment rather than an official series, so five products can be dated and the population they reach cannot (inclusion).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Eight Sierra Leonean banks are live on the continental cross-border local-currency rail, on the operator's own May 2025 register. The register of live commercial banks, version 015-05-25, names UBA, Sierra Leone Commercial Bank, Access Bank, Bloom Bank, Rokel Bank, GTBank, Vista Bank and FBNNBank under Sierra Leone, with SN Bank shown under channels (register). Being listed is the whole of what the register establishes. It carries no transaction volumes and no corridor-level detail, so the base can say the rail is available and nothing about whether it is used.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A national fraud roadmap was validated in August 2026, and no rule allocating the loss is held. The roadmap was validated at the close of a two-day workshop convening the operator, two ministries, the regulator and the central bank on registration, verification compliance and fraud reporting (roadmap , workshop , strategy). Its text, costing and timetable are not held, and the gap it addresses is unchanged: no liability rule, refund duty or reversal mechanism is proposed, so the consumer's position after a fraud is exactly where it was (alert , parliament). Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law, and the disagreement is unreconciled (scam , enforcement , allocation). Complaint volumes are operator-reported in a ministerial statement with no series and no earlier figure (complaints), and the operator's own scam-alert tool publishes no report volume, response time, remedy or referral route (tool).	MIXED a multi-agency fraud roadmap validated while no rule allocates the loss and the consumer's position after a fraud is unchanged
Registries	Population register	The national biometric register covers about 93 per cent of the population, under the 2016 Act that created the authority. Coverage stands at about 93 per cent with a unique identification number each, on a Tier III data centre with a live eKYC platform (register). The register's statutory basis is the National Civil Registration Act 2016, which vests it in an independent authority with a confidentiality duty (Act). Ninety-three per cent is a coverage figure and not a currency figure: no deaths-recorded rate, no update cycle and no de-duplication audit is published against it.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Civil register	Supplier engagement opened for an integrated digital mortality surveillance, registration and certification system, and no cost, supplier, timetable or coverage target is stated. Engagement opened in August 2026 (system). The coverage figure attached to it is the agency's own. Death registration at that level means the civil register captures a small fraction of deaths, which is what the system is meant to change and what nothing yet measures.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register	A national base map is in development, phase one covering Western Area Urban; the only addressing scheme in service is Freetown's use of Plus Codes. Phase one of the base map covers Western Area Urban District, built on OpenStreetMap with Japanese technical direction, with no cost, timetable, hosting arrangement or data licence stated (map); the innovation directorate announced the work in August 2026 (announcement). Freetown City Council's property reform uses Plus Codes for addressing (reform). There is no national address register. A base map is the layer under one, not the register itself, and the only operating scheme covers one city.	ADVANCED
Registries	Business register	A Companies and Business Registration Bill 2026 is drafted, following a budget proposal to launch 24-hour registration. The draft bill was published by the National Investment Board in March 2026 (bill). The board proposed a Le 22 million budget in October 2025 to drive investment and launch 24-hour business registration (budget); its own statutory basis is the National Investment Board Act 2022 (Act). No registration figure, no current turnaround time and no parliamentary stage for the bill is held, so the 24-hour claim has nothing to be measured against.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Social protection register	The social registry is being expanded towards national coverage, on data structures set out in a 2023 technical note. The registry's development began in 2014 under the Social Safety Net project, and its data structures and operationalisation are described in a World Bank technical note (note). The social action commission and the statistics office signed an amended memorandum on 8 April 2026 to take it to national coverage (memorandum). No household count, coverage percentage or update cycle is published, so national coverage is an intention with no distance from it stated.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register	Voter registration is under review, with a UNDP feasibility study published in December 2025. Registration is conducted under the Public Elections Act 2022 (Act). A feasibility study on voter registration, with analysis and recommendations, was published in December 2025 (study), and the tripartite technical sub-committee engaged the Electoral Commission in February 2026 on constitutional reform and on implementing the tripartite recommendations (engagement). No registered-voter figure, no decision on the study's recommendations and no link between the electoral roll and the national identity register is held.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register	The Finance Act 2026 extends the tax register to suppliers of digital services with no physical presence in the country. The register was constituted by the Finance Act 2020, which amended the Income Tax Act 2000 to require the Commissioner-General to keep a register of all persons liable to be assessed and to assign each a system-generated Tax Identification Number (2020 Act). The Finance Act 2026, in operation from 1 January 2026, brings within charge a person making a taxable supply of digital services to consumers in Sierra Leone whether or not they have a physical presence, and requires such a supplier to appoint a resident representative (2026 Act). No registered-taxpayer count is published, and no enforcement against a non-resident digital supplier is on record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	Customary land registration has begun chiefdom by chiefdom, under the National Land Commission Act 2022. Registration commenced in Bekeh Loko chiefdom (registration), parcel maps were validated by Rogbere Section 1 landowners in Maforki (validation), and land committees in both chiefdoms were pre-sensitised with the commission and FAO in May 2026 (orientation). The statutory basis is the 2022 Act establishing the National Land Commission (Act), and the project's implementation status report of December 2025 is the supervision record (report). Two chiefdoms is the extent of what is registered. No parcel count, no national register, and no timetable for extension beyond the pilot chiefdoms is held.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A digital health information system and electronic medical records rollout launched at its first facility in July 2026. The science and technology directorate and the pharmacy board signed a memorandum to advance digital pharmaceutical regulation (memorandum). The rollout launched at a paediatric centre on 27 July 2026 alongside the connectivity that carries it (rollout , launch). No facility count, record volume, interoperability arrangement or data-protection basis is published. The connectivity underneath it is a single foreign satellite operator under no public contract, so the health record and its transport share one point of failure.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Education	An education management information system runs the annual school census, under a digital learning strategy to 2030. The system is a unit and function of the Directorate of Basic Education, responsible for an integrated education information system (system); the 2021 annual school census final report is the base's fullest published output from it (census). A National Digital Learning Strategy 2025-2030 was published jointly with the Teaching Service Commission in April 2026 (strategy). The most recent census report in the base is four years old, and no annual publication series is established behind it.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	<i>Not held</i>, searched 2026-09-06 - the sector's own 2024-2030 strategy records no operating national case management system. The Justice Sector Reform Strategy 2024-2030 states that implementation of the previous strategic plan was hindered by inadequate and outdated data management systems, names poor case management infrastructure among the sector's current challenges, sets improved case management at all levels of the court system as its second strategic objective, and records no operating national justice case management information system (strategy). That is a dated, cited absence rather than an unexamined one: the institution that would own the system says in its own planning document that it does not have one.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Collection is going mobile at both levels - the revenue authority's non-tax revenue application in provincial rollout and a municipal property tax system out to tender. Surveyors were trained at Makeni in July 2026 to collect service fees through the authority's mobile payment application (application). The rollout of a municipal property tax system to Bo and Koidu New Sembehun city councils went to expressions of interest on 20 May 2026 (notice). The customs platform is recorded separately, and the trade body committed in January 2026 to expediting its upgrade (commitment). No collection figure is attached to any of the three, so the base can see the systems and not what they raise.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	The anti-corruption commission found an integrity failure in the customs system at the revenue authority, and no response, prosecution or remediation is on record. The commission's report is dated July 2026 and was serialised from August (report , audit). The report is held only as far as its background section, serialised verbatim, and the figure attached to it comes from a newspaper account of the same investigation rather than from the report. No revenue-authority response, prosecution or remediation is on record. A customs system whose integrity has been found wanting by the state's own anti-corruption body, with nothing published since, is the single clearest regression in this unit.	REGRESSED
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	Digitisation of government services is agency-reported with no service list or definition published, and three back-office systems – procurement, monitoring and audit – are in progress. The government launched a digital jobs portal stated as intended to break the nepotism cycle in youth employment (launch). No vacancy or placement figure is on the base. The digitisation figure is agency-reported, with no service list or definition published, so it cannot be checked against any service a citizen would use (services). Electronic procurement is advancing through bilateral cooperation with a neighbour whose own system is described as a regional model (procurement , model). A national monitoring and evaluation system is expanding with no coverage figure, publication rule or public access to the tracked project data stated (monitoring), and an audit management system completed post-configuration training with no cost, go-live date or audit scope stated (audit).	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	Council digitalisation runs through one project: RUSLP, a US\$50 million grant covering the Western Area and all six secondary cities. A 2023 readiness assessment measured the councils against institutional arrangements, people, data and systems for municipal spatial data infrastructure, and found them short on all four (assessment). The project is financed by a US\$50 million IDA grant with US\$6.73 million of GEF co-financing, its management unit housed in the Fiscal Decentralization Division, with spatial data infrastructure and urban property tax administration as the two subcomponents of its institutional capacity component (project). The statutory frame is the Local Government Act 2022 (Act). No council-level connectivity, hardware or staffing figure is published for any of the nineteen councils.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A municipal property tax system is out to tender for Bo and Koidu New Sembehun, against Freetown's existing property reform. The rollout consultancy was advertised on 20 May 2026 under the urban project, as the modernisation of municipal property tax administration (notice). Freetown City Council's own property reform, with Plus Codes for addressing, is the only council record system in service in the base (reform). No award, no property count for either city, and no revenue baseline against which the system could later be read.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	Satellite connectivity for 300 government health facilities launched its first site in July 2026, placing a national health dependency on one foreign operator with no public contract. The first site was launched at a paediatric centre on 27 July 2026 (launch , site). It places a national health information dependency on a single foreign satellite operator with no public contract. No value, term, service level or exit arrangement is published, and no alternative transport is named for any of the 300 facilities. That is the finding rather than the rollout: the country has chosen the fastest route to connecting its clinics and has published nothing about what happens if it stops.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	Sixteen digital learning hubs are under establishment, one per district, each with laptops, solar power and high-speed internet. The innovation directorate lists sixteen district hubs as active work with World Bank support, one per district, and plans digital skills training for 1,500 people across them (directorate). One fully equipped hub had already been donated to Lorenzo School, Waterloo, as a pilot (directorate). The first school tech club opened with UNICEF at the Annie Walsh Memorial School in July 2026 (club). Sixteen hubs and one club, against a school system whose size neither record states. No count of connected schools is published anywhere in the base.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	Computers were distributed to local unit commanders in July 2026, four years after equipment for 100 regional information system workstations was received. The Inspector General received equipment for 100 West African Police Information System workstations in October 2024 (equipment). Computers were handed to local unit commanders in July 2026 (computers). Neither record says how many stations are covered, where they are, or whether any of the workstations are in service. A distribution is not a deployment, and the base holds no station-level count.	ADVANCED

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	An artificial-intelligence-in-government partnership signed in October 2025 delivered cyber and artificial-intelligence training for senior civil servants in March 2026. The electoral commission publicly considered the use of artificial intelligence for the 2028 elections (report). Nothing states what function is contemplated or what safeguards would apply. The memorandum was signed at a United Nations session in October 2025 (partnership), and training for senior civil servants followed in March 2026 with the cyber coordination centre as a delivery partner (training). No system, deployment, cost or evaluation is published. The partnership is running ahead of the national strategy that would frame it, which is in development.	ADVANCED
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	An AI support tool for school quality assurance officers is in use, with a user feedback report published in March 2026. The report covers feedback from the officers using the tool in the field (report). This is the only sectoral system in the base with artificial intelligence in production use. No model, vendor, data source or evaluation against inspection outcomes is named, and no other sector has an equivalent.	ADVANCED
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Control of AI abuse	A deepfake and digital misinformation campaign has run since May 2026 across seven towns, with no legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanying it. The campaign has reached seven towns since May 2026 (campaign). No legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanies it: public literacy is standing in for regulation. That is the same substitution the fraud response makes, where consumer education runs while no rule allocates the loss.	ADVANCED
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The state operator was relaunched as a mobile virtual network operator on an Africell partnership in May 2026. The President relaunched Sierratel on 6 May 2026, presented as a stronger public-private partnership in the telecoms sector (relaunch); the ministry set out the arrangement as the relaunch of a national asset (ministry). Running as a virtual operator on another network is the opposite of production capacity: the state asset now sells service over infrastructure it does not own. No subscriber target, revenue figure or term for the partnership is published.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	A UniPod opened at Fourah Bay College in July 2026, above sixteen district digital learning hubs under establishment. The UniPod opened on the Mount Aureol campus, backed by government, the University of Sierra Leone, UNDP and Africell (hub). The innovation directorate's remit covers incubators, accelerators, innovation clusters, co-working spaces, research hubs and community hubs in underserved regions, and it lists sixteen district digital learning hubs as active work (directorate). A circular innovation lab for young people was announced with UNDP in March 2026 (lab). No hub is reported with occupancy, cohort numbers or a funding term, so none can be told apart from a launch.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	An angel investment network opened with a ministry framework agreement in December 2025, above a mapping of the entrepreneurship support organisations that serve founders. The Redsalt Angel Investment Network launched alongside a framework agreement with the ministry to co-fund and support early-stage startups (network). The International Trade Centre published a digital roadmap mapping the country's entrepreneurship support organisations (roadmap), and an e-commerce startup reached the Startup World Cup regional semi-finals in November 2025 (startup). No fund size, deal count or portfolio is published for the network. The advisory council recorded separately is the only standing governance the sector has.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	A civil service digital skills programme launched in July 2026 with 1,000 places in its first year. The programme launched with 1,000 first-year places (programme). No curriculum, completion measure or departmental coverage is published. It sits alongside the separately recorded senior civil-service training on cyber and artificial intelligence, and nothing states how the two relate.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	The first national measure puts adult digital literacy at 26 out of 100, with district scores ranging from 2.7 to 51.8. The baseline survey reports an overall adult digital literacy score of 26 of 100, district scores from 2.7 in Koinadugu and 8.5 in Pujehun to 51.8 in Western Area Rural and 41.5 in Western Area Urban, 48.7 per cent of adults owning a mobile phone of any type, 25 per cent able to save or delete a phone contact independently and 21.5 per cent able to send a text message (survey). Basic digital skills training was extended to 600 citizens from underserved communities in October 2025 (training). Six hundred people against a population where three adults in four cannot send a text message. The 2017 multiple indicator survey is the earlier statistical baseline (survey), and no comparable earlier digital literacy figure exists to read this one against.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	Computer Science is a core subject in the senior secondary curriculum, with the framework itself warning of staffing and resource constraints. The framework carries Computer Science among the core subjects of the sciences and technologies stream alongside ICT and Robotics, and Computer Literacy among the everyday subjects expected of every learner completing twelve years of schooling; it states that Robotics and Computer Literacy are likely to encounter staffing and resource challenges (framework). The first school tech club opened with UNICEF in July 2026 (club), and a student robotics tournament ran in January 2026 (tournament). The curriculum's own warning is the finding: no teacher count, equipment figure or entry statistic for any of these subjects is published.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A digital public goods university curriculum held its first academic exhibition in July 2026. The exhibition was held on 27 July 2026 (curriculum). The same event carried the announcement of the innovation investment fund and the reference to the open-source policy, so one exhibition is the source for three of this unit's forward commitments. No enrolment, institution count or graduate figure is published for the curriculum.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	A youth digital-literacy programme graduated eighty in August 2026, donor-funded and delivered by a non-governmental academy. Eighty graduated in August 2026 (programme). The outcome reports are the graduates' own and no tracer study is held, so what the programme produced beyond attendance is unmeasured. It is the only youth training instrument in this ledger.	ADVANCED
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	The science and innovation council is developing its first strategic plan, with digital transformation named among the priorities funded research should answer. A three-day workshop on strategic development, research funding and grants management convened the higher education ministry, the National Science, Technology and Innovation Council, the National Council for Higher Education and the Southern African Research and Innovation Management Association; the Deputy Minister named digital transformation among the national priorities alongside food security, healthcare, climate resilience, industrialisation and quality education (workshop). The research and education network connecting the universities has run from a secretariat at Njala University since 2016 (network). A council without a strategic plan and a network without a published output list is the whole of the research contribution the base can see. No think tank, department or published policy paper is named.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	No general portal: complaints run through the statutory Ombudsman and through project-level grievance mechanisms. The Ombudsman Act 1997 is the standing national complaint mechanism, empowering investigation of any administrative act on written complaint by a person claiming injustice from maladministration, with maladministration defined to include failing to reply to correspondence and unreasonable delay; no digital channel appears in the Act (Act). The digital integration project's stakeholder engagement plan sets out a toll-free hotline, SMS, e-mail, community grievance boxes at local council, direct reporting to safeguards specialists and walk-ins, with acknowledgement within two days and a grievance resolution committee meeting monthly (plan); the land administration project reports separately on its own mechanism (report). Both are donor project mechanisms that end with the project. Nothing in the base is a government service channel for feedback on services generally.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	The Local Government Act 2022 requires consultation and open council meetings, and the data protection Bill was taken round the country before validation. The Act requires ministries to consult, obliges councillors to consult their electorate, opens council and ward committee meetings to the public and establishes ward committees whose resident members are elected at public meetings (Act). Nationwide consultations on the data protection and access to information Bill began in September 2025 (start) and concluded in Bo later that month (conclusion). Budget preparation ran its own bilateral discussions from September 2025 (budget). No consultation report, submission count or record of what changed as a result is published for any of them.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity	Gender-responsive budgeting widened from five ministries to ten for FY2026, under the Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment Act 2022. The FY2026 Gender Budget Statement records that the partnership began in FY2024 with five pilot ministries and that guidelines under the first budget call circular covered ten pilot bodies for FY2026; gender units or focal persons are designated across 28 ministries, departments and agencies but not yet fully functional (statement). The statutory basis is the Gender Equality and Women's Empowerment Act 2022, which institutionalised the approach (Act), and a gender accountability framework was validated in February 2026 (framework). Nothing in the budgeting frame reaches digital services. No sex-disaggregated figure for phone ownership, internet use or identity registration is published in the base.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	Assistive devices were handed to disability institutions in November 2025, under the digital transformation project. The ministry handed over the devices with support from the digital transformation project (handover). The education ministry's inclusion champions programme is the sector's own approach to inclusive education (brief), and the 2015 census thematic report on disability is the statistical baseline (report). An eleven-year-old census is the most recent population figure the base holds on disability, and no accessibility requirement attaches to any government digital service on record.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	An ECOWAS-supported project for displaced and stateless people launched in January 2026, paying beneficiaries through a commercial bank. The project launched at Tiama Town on 8 January 2026, covering internally displaced people, refugees, returnees, stateless people, asylum seekers and host populations, with beneficiary tokens distributed through the Sierra Leone Commercial Bank (launch). The statutory frame is the Refugees Protection Act 2007, which gives effect to the 1951 Convention, the 1967 Protocol and the 1969 OAU Convention and establishes the National Refugee Authority and the Refugee Status Appeal Committee (Act); the disaster management agency recorded internal displacement from the Kono windstorm in June 2026 (displacement). No registration figure, caseload or link to the national identity register appears for any displaced population.	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	Internet penetration is unchanged, and the gap the evidence points at is usage against investment rather than coverage. A separate 2024 estimate is on file alongside the current figure; the definitions differ and both are kept dated rather than merged (penetration , estimate). The usage measure sets telecommunications investment against what is actually used; its price series is an attributed opposition critique rather than an official statistic (usage , critique). Backbone reaching 14 of 16 districts against a usage gap of this shape is the argument for device affordability and price over further build, and the only instrument aimed there is a private financing scheme with unpublished terms.	NO CHANGE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The extended second national statistics strategy is in force, and a Power of Data framework to 2030 was published in December 2025. The extended strategy was issued by Statistics Sierra Leone in November 2023 as the national statistical system's modernisation strategy (strategy). The Power of Data Sierra Leone Country Framework 2026-2030 was reviewed nationally in November 2025 (review) and published with the planning ministry, the statistics office and UNFPA in December (framework). Two overlapping frames now run over the same system, one to 2030 and one extended from a period that has closed. Neither carries a costing or a delivery report in the base.	ADVANCED
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	The 2026 census and the 2026 demographic and health survey are both launched, five years after the first digital census. The 2026 Population and Housing Census was launched on 1 December 2025 alongside the national data initiatives of the Power of Data framework (launch), and the 2026 Demographic and Health Survey was officially launched on 4 August 2026 (survey). The 2021 mid-term census was the country's first digital census and its final results are published (census). Two national collections launched inside nine months and no enumeration date, budget or field methodology published for either. A launch is a commitment to collect, and the base holds nothing beyond it.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Two administrative systems now publish: the school census from the education system and the financial system's annual report. The education management information system runs the annual school census and its 2021 final report is published (census). The Accountant General's 2025 annual report records that Phase II of the integrated financial management system reached 56 further ministries, departments and agencies, that 56 subvented agencies were trained on it and on electronic funds transfer, and that those agencies must process all withdrawals and petty cash through it from January 2026 (report). Neither is published as a statistical series. The rebased gross domestic product on a 2018 base year is the one national account output in the base (GDP), and it is a survey product rather than an administrative one.	ADVANCED
Open data	Use of open data	Three public-use microdata files were released in the period, ending with version 2 of the 2024 women's empowerment and nutrition survey. The Annual Agricultural Survey 2023 public-use file was released in November 2025 (2023 survey), the Annual Agricultural Survey 2024 microdata in April 2026 (2024 survey) and the second version of the Women's Empowerment and Nutrition Survey 2024 in May 2026 (WEN survey). Three releases in seven months from one producer is the whole of the open data activity in the base. No government open data portal, no licence statement and no dataset inventory outside the statistics catalogue is held, and the two open data policies recorded separately bind one sector and one commission.	ADVANCED
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	A coordination and visualisation platform launched in July 2026 under a geospatial memorandum, and a national base map is in development with a feasibility mission still ahead. The platform launched on 6 July 2026 under a memorandum signed the previous week (platform). The base map was announced in August 2026 with the feasibility mission still to come (base map). Neither states a data-licensing arrangement, and both are delivered with foreign partners. The country is acquiring a national geospatial layer through partnerships whose terms are unpublished.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	A climate information systems project became effective in June 2026, alongside a hydromet diagnostics peer review. The Green Climate Fund's funded activity agreement for SAP033, enhancing climate information systems for resilient development, became effective on 10 June 2026 (project). The Systematic Observations Financing Facility published a country hydromet diagnostics peer review report in June 2026 (review). Both are inputs to an observation system rather than evidence of one. No station count, forecast product or satellite data feed in operational use is named in either.	ADVANCED

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	Two instruments: a US\$129 million health cooperation memorandum with a data-sovereignty clause, and the US\$480 million energy compact now under a seated board. The health memorandum was signed on 22 December 2025 for five years from 2026 to 2030, over four thematic areas, with a Joint Health Cooperation Steering Committee and a stated protection of data sovereignty, regulatory authority and national development priorities (memorandum). The Millennium Challenge Account board held its inaugural meeting on 28 January 2026 under the Vice President, on a US\$480 million energy compact (board); the compact's own programme description is published by the corporation (compact). No hyperscaler engagement of any kind appears in the base. The data-sharing agreement that accompanies the health memorandum is withheld, which is recorded on that row.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	The 2024 joint statement is the standing frame, and what has followed it is education and infrastructure rather than digital. The joint statement of the state visit of 27 February to 2 March 2024 deepened the comprehensive strategic cooperative partnership, recorded the signing of a Cooperation Plan on Jointly Promoting the Belt and Road Initiative, and recorded accession to the Group of Friends of the Global Development Initiative and addition to its project pool (statement). Since then a joint education programme launched at Freetown Polytechnic with China Railway Seventh Group (programme) and an industrial fishing port was opened (port). No digital-sector instrument, financing or equipment supply appears under the partnership anywhere in the base.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The Multi-Annual Indicative Programme 2021-2027 carries digital targets, and the first EIB loan to a domestic bank was signed in October 2025. The programme carries digital transformation and data technology among the EU priorities and sets targets of 650,000 people benefiting from EU-supported digital services and 100,000 with enhanced access to digital government services, from a baseline of zero, alongside an integrated national civil register of vital statistics (programme). The European Investment Bank signed EUR 10 million with Vista Bank (SL), its first intermediated loan to a Sierra Leonean bank, under EFSD+ and the Global Gateway strategy (loan); a EUR 22 million green mini-grid facility launched through the EU delegation in October 2025 (facility). No progress report against the programme's digital targets is published, so the base holds the targets and nothing measured against them.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement with the United Arab Emirates was signed in February 2026, naming artificial intelligence first among priority sectors. The two presidents witnessed the signing in Abu Dhabi on 2 February 2026, on the margins of the World Governments Summit; the statement names artificial intelligence, energy, agriculture, infrastructure, logistics and healthcare as priority sectors and notes prospects for defence and military cooperation (statement). Other Gulf financing in the period is not digital: the Islamic Development Bank approved a Freetown water and aquatic environment project in December 2025 (bank) and the OPEC Fund a US\$50 million rice processing loan in March 2026 (fund). The agreement text is not published, and no data centre, connectivity or artificial intelligence project follows it in the base.	ADVANCED
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A standing relationship of training slots and tele-education, above which officials joined a learning mission on digital public infrastructure. India's own bilateral brief records a tele-education and telemedicine centre inaugurated in July 2021 under a 2019 memorandum, an ITEC allocation raised from 50 to 86 training slots in 2024-25, scholarships expanded from 15 to 50, and digital infrastructure among the standing bilateral tracks alongside lines of credit that include US\$32 million for a university of science and technology at Koidu (brief). A further line of credit financed potable water works, tendered in January 2026 (tender). Senior officials joined a south-south learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure, hosted by UNDP, with Karnataka receiving the delegation on 1 September 2026 (mission). Training and exposure, with no digital agreement, financing or technology transfer named on either side.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud	Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law; unreconciled as at 2026-08-09.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate	A staffing, skills-audit or operations report from NaTCA, DSTI or the NCRA covering who runs the national systems and with what capacity.	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement	The signed agreement or a published summary stating what data classes flow, on what legal basis and with what retention limit.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for data sharing between government registers	A data-sharing instrument, regulation or protocol governing exchanges between the identity register and other agencies.	not yet probed
Bank of Sierra Leone RTGS and ACH re-platforming	An award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the National Public Procurement Authority for references 8922483/8922484, naming supplier, value and scope. The only listing found was an inadmissible-origin tender aggregator, retired 2026-08-10; neither contracting authority's procurement page carries a matching entry.	2026-08-10
Court case management system	A judiciary or Justice Sector Coordination Office record of a deployed case management system, or a procurement award for one.	2026-09-06

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-07
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress-2026-09-07.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.